Animal bites- First Aid Management

- Wash the wound from the bite thoroughly with soap and warm water as it can reduce the risk of infection from an animal bite.
- Raise and support the wound and then cover it with a sterile wound dressing.
- If the wound is large or deep, then treat for bleeding.
- If there's a risk of rabies, then you need to get them to hospital as fast as you can.

If the bite is from another human, there's also a risk of getting hepatitis or HIV/ AIDS viruses.

9.8 Cardio Pulmonary Resuscitation (CPR)



CPR stands for cardio-pulmonary resuscitation. It's a life saving medical procedure which is given to someone who is in cardiac arrest. It helps to pump blood around the person's body when their heart can't.

To carry out CPR a person presses up and down on the casualty's chest (chest compressions) and gives them a series of rescue breaths to help save their life when they are in cardiac arrest.

CPR comprises the following 3 steps, performed in order:

- Chest compressions
- Airway
- Breathing.

Indications and contra indications

CPR should be performed immediately on any person who has become unconscious and is found to be pulseless and absence of breathing.

Contra indications

- The only absolute contra indication to CPR is a do-not-resuscitate (DNR) order or other advanced directive indicating a person's desire to not be resuscitated in the event of cardiac arrest.

6 Major CPR steps

Before starting CPR check is the environment safe for the person.

Step 1: Shake and shout

If the person appears unconscious tap or shake the shoulders ask loudly are you (ok)? No response call for help.

Step 2: Check for normal breathing and circulation

Check if the person is breathing normally by looking for:

- regular chest movements
- listening for breathing
- feeling for breath on your cheek.
- Check if the person has circulation by placing the index and middle fingers on the neck to the side of wind pipe.
- If there is no pulse and breathing start chest compression and rescue breathing,
  - If the person is breathing normally, then put them in the recovery position

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